The Ideological Difference Between Eastern & Western Videogames and Its Consequences

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Introduction

This essay argues the principal reason for design differences between Eastern and Western videogames is not socioeconomic factors — which is the dominant position of literature, e.g. in Navarro-Remesal & Loriguillo-López (2015) — but ideology; ergo they are not malleable but cultural, recommending rejection of global monoculture. "West" and "East" mean hereinafter cultures shaped by Liberalism and Individualism, and Confucianism and Collectivism, respectively. "Liberalism", as far as it is used within this essay, refers to Classical ("English") Liberalism, rather than its modern (chiefly American) usage that refers particularly to left-wing "progressive" thought. Comparison begins with distinction between American and Japanese roleplaying games (RPGS), identifying also how perceived differences manifest within Europe, or China and Korea, and across genres.

Differences

There is existing classification of JPRGS (Japanese RPGS) against WRPGS (Western RPGS). WRPGS originate[3] with American *Ultima* (Origin Systems, 1981) and *Wizardry* (Sir-Tech, 1981), the latter inspiring the dungeon-crawler genre specifically; one can trace their foundations further back, to tabletop RPGS, and then even further to seminal Western fantasy literature (e.g. *The Lord of the Rings* (Tolkien, 1954-5)) that continue to influence both WRPGS and JRPGS today (Killingsworth, 2022). The first JRPG, *Dragon Quest* (Chunsoft, 1986), was inspired by both — particularly Wizardry — focussing on character, simplifying mechanics, and

streamlining progression for console-based audiences borne from Nintendo Famicom (a.k.a. Nintendo Entertainment System (NES) in the West) fans rather than computer hobbyists (Kohler, 2004).

Importantly, JRPG is often — and for the purposes of this essay — interpreted as a genre label rather than a description: games like *Dark Souls* (FromSoftware, 2011), while Japanese RPGs, are not JRPGs. I shall use "Japanese RPG" where I am referring literally to an RPG developed in Japan, as opposed to a game that specifically adopts the normative characteristics of the JRPG as a genre. So it is that evolution from *Dragon Quest*, while satisfactory by itself for explaining the genre distinction between JRPG and WRPG, cannot justify the design of Eastern RPGs more generally, which continue borrowing from Western rather than domestic lineage: Japanese *King's Field* (FromSoftware, 1994) hearkens *Wizardry*, and *Elden Ring* (FromSoftware, 2022) Western open-world RPGs (Killingsworth). Hutchinson (2019) draws more consistent design distinctions: all RPGs intend players' immersion, but while JRPGs generally achieve this through characterisation and narrative (e.g. *Final Fantasy*, Square, 1987-present), WRPGs tend to through worldbuilding and agency (e.g. *The Elder Scrolls*, Bethesda, 1994-present). Without disregarding the importance of all these aspects within RPGs across the globe, it can be said the focusses are different. For example, straying from RPG norms, immersive city environments are aimed at in both Japanese *Shenmue* (AM2, 1999) and British *Grand Theft Auto: San Andreas* (Rockstar, 2004); nevertheless, both achieve their immersion in line with this generalisation: *Shenmue*'s Yokosuka is small but believable for its detail and character interactions; *San Andreas* is immersive for its size and explorative freedom. Likewise, Polish *The Witcher 3* (CD Projekt, 2015), while having stronger narrative and characterisation than most WRPGs, offers a richer world with more side-content than most Japanese equivalents (narrative action-RPGs) such as *NieR:Automata* (PlatinumGames, 2017).

There still appear exceptions. Within online RPGs, Korean *Black Desert* (Pearl Abyss, 2015) focusses player-expression more than American *The Elder Scrolls Online* (ZeniMax, 2014), which has stronger narratives. Hutchinson notes JRPGs reward perseverance, even through repetition. This can be extended to other East Asian games: "grinding" is the practice — common particularly of JRPGs — wherein progression is facilitated by voluntary repetition of mundane tasks; *Black Desert* features more grinding than *The Elder Scrolls Online*, which is less restrictive regarding what the player can access relative to time investment. Santos (2015) extends this observation to the hack-and-slash genre, contrasting how the player is challenged in Japanese *Bayonetta* (PlatinumGames, 2009) and American *God of War* (Santa Monica Studios, 2005), observing Western games aim at empowerment, while such must be earned in Eastern games. *Elden Ring*, while discouraging grinding, similarly restricts progression till sufficient demonstration of skill and diligence.

Hutchinson explores how characterisation impacts further aspects of games. In JRPGs, character is often related to theming, with stories exploring difficult relationships with parents, which Hutchinson associates with recent changes in familial relationships in Japan that contrast with traditions. Even in *Elden Ring*, director Miyazaki admits early story concepts centred "parent-and-child relationships" (quoted in Killingsworth). Amnesiac or outsider protagonists are common across RPGs: in JRPGs, usually as a plot-point, whereby learning about their past, developing the story, explaining diegetic hierarchies — e.g. in Japanese *Final Fantasy X* (Square, 2001) and *Persona 5* (Atlus, 2016); in WRPGs as contrivance enabling backstory-imagining for avatars — e.g. in American *The Elder Scrolls*

III: Morrowind (Bethesda Game Studios, 2002) and Canadian *Star Wars: Knights of the Old Republic* (BioWare, 2003). Note that hierarchy is especially relevant in Eastern games given its importance in their culture, which will be explored later. Either way it is conducive to worldbuilding: in JRPGs insofar as necessary for story and character dynamics, whereas worldbuilding is focal to WRPGs. Exceptions undoubtedly exist, however even in Eastern games with especially strong worldbuilding — such as *Elden Ring* and *Black Desert* — the worldbuilding is not focal, but an optional part of the experience suitable to enhance, not make, it. Characters in JRPGs experience growth at significant points, moreover the whole story climaxes towards the end; WRPGs focus on world- over character-building, relying on the gestalt of the game-world's minutiae rather than narrative. While a rich world can enhance an Eastern RPG, for Western RPGs, it is more often the world itself that *is* the game. Conversely, while characters certainly enrich Western RPGs, they do not make up the backbone of the experience. There are indeed WRPGs featuring parties of characters, such as Canadian Baldur's Gate (BioWare, 1998), but members are recruited foremost to benefit gameplay rather than story.

Games such as Elden Ring that eschew superficial Japanese character are termed *mukokuseki* (無国籍), i.e. non-cultural, lit. "stateless" or "lacking in membership to a country". Within this context, the term was applied by Iwabuchi (2002), who translated it as "odourless" — lacking distinct cultural elements, instead being culturally bland or basic, and so equally accessible to foreign audiences. Supposedly, the purpose is to make games globally marketable (Grau, 2019); withal global successes of games forefronting Japanese culture supposedly owe to the inverse: self-Orientalism (Hutchinson). *Katamari Damacy* (Namco, 2004) allegedly flaunts Japaneseness (Hutchinson; Grau), humouring Western perceptions of Japanese weirdness (Hutchinson; Bramwell, 2006). However, O'Hagan (2009) correctly identifies culture is so embedded within videogames that localisation cannot undo it, and cultural differences manifest within all aspects of the game, including the mechanics; even with intentional *mukokuseki* applied, games are still Foucauldian products of their environment. O'Hagan gives the example of *Ico* (Sony, 2005), which despite a Western-looking environment and characters not distinctly Japanese speaking in a fictional language, is unmistakably Japanese with deliberate camera-angles favouring design over agency — a feature of Eastern games explained in the next section.

Mukokuseki exposes discrepancy between games' presentation and behaviour, this being significant for confirming distinction between Eastern and Western games. While Hutchinson observes Japanese RPGs' focus on characterisation, *The Witcher 3* contextualises the player's purpose within Geralt and Ciri's relationship as does Japanese *Shadow of the Colossus* (Sony, 2005) between Wander and Mono. In the former, when immersed in gameplay, the player's focus is gaining strength and exploring, as traditional of WRPGs; the latter has no additional feature of the game motivating the player beyond desire to help Mono. Similarly, the barrenness of *Shadow of the Colossus*' world fosters a closer relationship between Wander and his steed Agro than *Witcher 3*'s bustling world permitting fast-travel fosters between Geralt and Roach, despite Geralt's horse being more directly characterised: horse-riding is sometimes necessary within quests, also Roach can be enhanced with new equipment; but despite Geralt also being shown to have a close connexion with his horse, the relatively low utility of Roach throughout gameplay fosters no such connexion between Roach and the player. Moreover, the expressive characters of American *Uncharted 4* (Naughty Dog, 2016) operate as background elements sometimes making platforming more interesting,

while *Ico*'s Yorda is relevant to all gameplay. With superficial context stripped away, Eastern or Western characteristics surface.

Ideology

Western Individualist and Eastern Collectivist social structures create independent and interdependent conceptions of "self". That is, generally-speaking, Westerners seek validation from within, and East-Asians from others (Markus & Kitayama, 1991). The West encourages realisation of individual potential while East-Asian concepts of personhood manifest in relation to others, with behaviour always contextual (ibid.). Markus and Kitayama contrast Chinese conception of the individual as an incomplete part of a social whole with Cartesian dualism that separates the self from the material world (Descartes, 2008[1641]). Independence favours autonomy; interdependence other-focussed emotions and co-dependence (Markus & Kitayama). Western and Eastern philosophy draw upon, then perpetuate, ideological practice. Confucianism fosters social-harmony, with its principal virtue *rén* (仁), harmonious behaviour (ibid.), referred to as *jen* in Markus & Kitayama, using the older Wade Giles romanisation. This is echoed in Japanese *wa* (和), interpersonal harmony (ibid.). Liberalism, meanwhile, prioritises individual freedoms, and battles to justify authority as conducive to liberty (Hobbes, 1993[1651]; Locke, 1993[1689]). This contrasts with Eastern favourability for rigid hierarchical structure and strong authority conducive to harmony (Grayling, 2019).

Given conceptions of "self" drive cognition, emotions, and motivations (Markus & Kitayama), it would seem they affect videogame design. However, most existing literature justifies differences as consequences of incidental socioeconomic conditions. Picard (2013) denies an essential aspect to Japanese games: they are entirely products of their market. The argument is that the Japanese games industry emerged in the arcades, owing to a large existing entertainment sector, then expanding into homes via consoles through the success of the Famicom (ibid.). By contrast, the West ushered gaming through a predominantly PC market because computer hobbyists, becoming independent developers, led the industry; Picard suggests a reason for Japan being slower to cultivate a large PC market is because displaying Japanese and Chinese characters required special software and machines. Hutchinson ventures slightly further, exploring influences of geopolitics, history, national identity, and familial relations within Japanese games, but in a contemporary and mutable framing. The limitation of these views is, as identified, the persistence of certain characteristics across East Asia, where contemporary social issues and politics, and the platforms on which games are played, differ. For example, Chinese games resemble Japanese despite targeting PC and mobile platforms; the government of the People's Republic of China enforced a ban on consoles between 2000 and 2015. South Korea, too, has a larger PC market than Japan, and yet particular game characteristics persist.

Furthermore, the market is not incidental: console-gaming's dominance in Japan, and by extension dominant design features in the industry, were ideologically influenced. The popularity of "game-centres" (ゲームセンター), i.e. Japanese video or amusement arcades, as with computer cafés across East Asia, indicate a culture separating leisure and home-life. Nintendo broke through by marketing its "Family Computer" as congenial to the household, with separate games targeting adults and children. That it was marketed as "Nintendo

Entertainment System" in the West is telling of ideological factors: in the West it was not considered important to market it for family, and "Computer" would connote creative programmability common of computers in the West but not East. Moreover, it was the first home system to profit mainly from games, which paired with the restriction against programmability, moved the Japanese industry towards quality, familiarity, and marketability, with games now being higher quality, ports of recognisable arcade games, or using familiar licenses (ibid.). Not disregarding Japanese "indie" games, the West's games industry ostensibly owes more to experimentation, modification, and independent projects, for example, in the evolution of the first-person shooter genre through iterative modification (e.g. *DOOM* (id Software, 1993) to *Quake* (id Software, 1996) to *Half Life* (Valve, 1998) to *Counter Strike* (Valve, 2000), and the longevity of *The Elder Scrolls* titles through player modifications. Also, with major, mainstream independent games e.g. *Minecraft* (Markus Persson, 2011), while Japanese independent games are generally smaller in scope (primarily products of RPG-Maker, or visual novels), sustaining more niche relevance towards exclusively other independent games, e.g. *Yume Nikki* (Kikiyama, 2004). .

Ideology's practice in the workplace also influences the industry. Following the principle of *wa*, Japanese are often hired from school (Winterhalter, 2007) and employed for life, fostering workplace harmony (Moriguchi & Ono, 2004). Consequently, Japanese games companies tend towards perfection rather than innovation. Moreover, individuals are not generally rewarded, but departments (Winterhalter). This practice is echoed in the aforementioned championing of perseverance in Japanese games, and selfless motivations. Zagal (2014) notes aspiring game-designers in Japan usually have a clear idea of the games they want to make based on games they already admire, rarely seeking to venture beyond what they are comfortable with. Though this might not be unique to Japan (Zagal notes it is also true in the USA), it supports that if ideology can provoke differences in game design initially, those features will perpetually become more prominent.

Having explored how Eastern standards of interpersonal relations and harmony affect the industry as a whole, let us identify how they affect games' design. Artistic objects are products of designers' ways of thinking (Hutchinson), and one component of "harmony" is conformity: Japanese's propensity to internalise emotions invites emotionally-complex characters in videogames, through whom emotion can be acknowledged (Kalata, 2007), e.g. in *Persona* (1996-present). Interdependence also manifests in how Eastern games centralise relationships for motivation: how characters motivate the protagonist (Hutchinson) but also how the player is motivated, as explored earlier in *Shadow of the Colossus*. Hierarchy, as constructive to harmony, is intrinsic to Eastern games. Japanese hierarchies are revealed in speech, and this is present in dialogue nuances in JRPGS, conducive to worldbuilding and character-personality (Hutchinson), beneficial to constructing sympathetic and believable characters relevant to plot and gameplay. Moreover, interdependence enforces comparative manifestation of personhood relative to others (Markus & Kitayama) — expressed within Chinese *Genshin Impact*'s (miHoYo, 2020) "gacha" mechanics (Adams, 2022), which disperse the self amongst predetermined characters, enabling the player comfortable entry to a pre-ordered system rather than being required to define one from chaos (ibid.): Confucian thought believes the natural state to be good, discouraging interference (Grayling). "Gacha" systems, common of many Eastern games, derive their name from *gachapon* (ガチャポン), i.e. Japanese capsule vending machines, and utilise that same mechanic of randomised rewards. They usually operate using a live-service model. *Genshin Impact* is Chinese, not Japanese, but

the popular terminology is ubiquitous. Another effect is that Western favourability for freedom rationalises the importance of player autonomy and self-expression in Western games, whereas Eastern games more greatly subject the player to the designer's particular vision (Clarendon, Red Fly Studios, cited in Kalata), as identified in *Ico* — in a sense giving the designer authority over the player, rather than giving the player authority over the game.

The "perseverance" characteristic, in particular, identified earlier of Eastern games, is connected to multiple cultural ideas. Hutchinson associates disciplined practice fostered by Japanese *Street Fighter* (Capcom, 1987-present) to that of traditional Japanese martial-arts training. Kalata contrasts American *SimCity* (Maxis, 1989) and Japanese *Harvest Moon* (Amccus, 1996), noting the Western audience enjoy control, and the Japanese nurture, identifying this with agrarian tradition. Agrarianism relates also to Individualist and Collectivist divergence, according to wheat-farming benefiting from ingenuity and technological advancement more than rice-farming, which required greater interdependence and coordination (Talhelm, 2022).

Ramifications

Given ideological basis for differences in design, it follows these are not incidental nor intentional, thus not arbitrary nor mutable, but deeply cultural. Where former analysis encourages culturalisation towards global monoculture, this new framing encourages cultural preservation beneficial to intransigence between East and West, and their individual merits.

Invocation of *mukokuseki* is a detriment for applying intentionality to games' cultural quality, divisively defining games as either *mukokuseki* or "self Orientalising". The former ignores idiosyncrasies of Japanese games; the latter mandates a Western framing of Japanese culture from which accurate portrayal will be exotic. Consequently, the presentation of Japanese games is viewed as an intentional projection unto the West, rather than inherent. Theories drawing on *mukokuseki* consider games' presentation deliberately bland or exoticised for global markets, ignoring earnest presentation of culture, fallaciously considering all expression of culture intentional rather than emergent, furthermore rendering normative Western culture. This has negatively affected analysis of Eastern games. Fundamentally, the Orient is exotic to Western eyes, and vice-versa; game developers from both hemispheres have different cultural and ideological backgrounds. *Persona 5* was the first *Persona* game to be principally set in a real Japanese location, Tokyo, featuring many of the city's districts as playable locations, and making prominent landmarks such as the Tokyo Tower — prior *Persona* games were set in fictional Japanese towns; and the game presents Japanese culture incredibly honestly: it is rich with Japanese culture, but it is not exoticised, with Tokyo being authentically cosmopolitan, having an American amongst the main cast, and tackling difficult social topics relevant to Japan; but nor is the game culturalised, as it does not conform to Western social standards. Despite not adhering to the aforementioned theories of the attributes of successful Japanese games, *Persona 5* has since become the most successful entry in the series globally, prompting multiple spin-off titles, and so calling *mukokuseki*'s legitimacy into question. *Mukokuseki* also assumes that Japanese games are successful globally because of the absence of certain qualities, rather than qualities' presence; analysis would suggest the most globally popular Japanese games are popular because of their

excellent design that excels them beyond most Western games, rather than the absence of self-evidently "Japanese" characteristics.

Mukokuseki does exist insofar as it affects the practices of a minority of Japanese companies, such as Kojima Productions, intentionally moving towards the global market (Consalvo, 2009). Grau notes *Metal Gear Solid 4* (Kojima Productions, 2008) as the exemplification of *mukokuseki*, claiming its popularity owes to its recognition of contemporary issues; however these are notably American in focus, for example military interventionism (Hutchinson), so aligning with criticism that *mukokuseki* falls into American globalism. The game was indeed more popular in the USA and Britain than Japan. *Mukokuseki* as in *Metal Gear Solid 4* also exposes that Japan views the West as a homogeneity; smoothing over cultural and traditional discrepancies existent in the West or East enables a globalist monoculture dictated by the dominant culture, in this case the USA.

O'Hagan believes awareness of cultural difference to benefit cross-cultural design, wherein games are designed for a global audience; I believe in the opposite approach. Recognition of the pervasiveness of cultural ideology within a product should not encourage that they are purged; a game made to resonate with a culturally synonymous domestic audience should not be compromised in its vision in order to appeal to outsiders – who should themselves adapt if wishing to appreciate cultural media. That games are fundamentally approached differently by Eastern and Western players discourages the normalisation of a single mode. Keever (2022) identifies that ideological structures perpetually enforce that same ideology in their products, so games are inherently ideological. Playing involves interaction with that ideology, so ideologically foreign players face conflict. Tripathy (2023) considers "proper" engagement with the freedom offered by Western game-worlds to demand Liberal rationality; Harrington and Zhang (2022) observe that Chinese players manifested a collective goal of their own, in the absence of one, within American *H1Z1* (Daybreak Company, 2018), according to "naturalised" moral imperative towards patriotism. This was a widespread incident wherein Chinese players would identify one another by wearing red shirts, then collaborate despite the 4-player limit to team sizes, so invariably winning the game through cheating. Likewise, Western standards explain comparative discomfort towards grinding and gacha mechanics. Western players find a dissonance between *Genshin Impact*'s presentation as an RPG and its live service mechanics, as the player is not rewarded for engaging with the RPG world and mechanics, but rather the gacha mechanics — requiring more monetary or time investment — as evidenced by Messner's (2020) review. This could be attributed to the lesser place of perseverance within Western games; though it is often associated with *Genshin Impact* being a free-to-play game, rather than for cultural factors (Notis, 2020; Kemps, 2020). Nevertheless, the ability of cultures to design congruently with their ideology is positive, as is global exposure to these cultural products.

The problem is that Western egalitarianism believes that everything should be for everyone. O'Hagan explores *Ico*'s Japanese essence with a view to culturalising it — making it palatable — for a global audience. But even as a Japanese game, *Ico* was unconventional; features O'Hagan identified were not Japanese idiosyncrasies but products of careful, intentional design. Western egalitarianism accepts differences in design insofar as they are palatably and immediately identifiable as exotic, or fit within a monocultural system. O'Hagan praises *Ico*'s non-verbal storytelling because it fits into a monocultural order without language barriers, but all other features are considered expendable. Non-verbal storytelling cannot be

normalised within Japanese games, which rely upon nuances in dialogue that do not exist in English to establish hierarchies and reveal personalities (Hutchinson): cultural homogeneity prevents that acute resonance of games intended for a specific culture.

Another reason for discouragement of culturalisation is games' status as invaluable expressions of culture. Beadle (2022) examines how gamification intensifies religious tradition in Taiwanese horror games; the flow-state afforded by excellent games enables effective absorption of information through habituation (ibid.; Jacobs, 2020). Hutchinson notes how gamification is conducive to ideological messaging: *Katamari Damacy*'s gameplay loop of interaction with nostalgic Japanese objects evokes sentimentality[28] of the *furusato* (故郷, "hometown). She notes gameplay is more important than narrative ideologically, as it is effective from beginning till end. Grau similarly notes, in relation to *Katamari Damacy*, that games are capable of strengthening culture through practical repetition.

Criticism of culturalisation should not be construed as advocacy of insularity, noting Wirman (2015) boldly suggests the People's Republic of China's lifting of the console-ban is Westernisation; openness to other media is not destructive to one's own culture. Wirman further criticises British media for even covering the PRC's games industry and daring to judge it. However awareness of other practices can occur without enforcement of monoculture, and can progress industries in the case of enabling the PRC to become more open: Wirman notes British coverage of the Chinese games-industry becoming more positive as the PRC became less restrictive. Requiring that Western countries be ambivalent to the practices of the East is, itself, a rejection of cultural values, and a suggestion that ideology is ultimately meaningless. Asking, as Wirman does, that either East or West not construct an Other in opposition to the Self, is effectively a rejection of Self, enabling homogenisation. Similarly, Santos acknowledges cross influence of Eastern and Western games towards a globalised industry — which is fine provided the globalised industry is diverse rather than monocultural.

Whilst Western games' Liberalism evokes the issue of culturalisation, so too do Eastern games' Collectivism evoke issues of their own. Adams observes within gacha games utilisation of gacha labour towards emotional investment in digital characters (facilitated by interdependent ideology), enabling the construction of a "meta-person" composed of the individual and their character. Players continue to identify with their character outside of the game, in other digital settings and the real-world. Adams forebodingly sees this as conducive to the establishment of unity between the corporeal and digital-selves, realising a neo-Socialist metaverse enforced by digital ID. Moreover he argues the gacha rewards system is mechanically Socialist, as players pay into the system with time and money; the game's morality, that being the player's purpose within the game, is not within the world or narrative, but the time investment towards work (ibid.).

Tripathy also suggests flow-states are conducive to malleability to authority, claiming this is qualitative of "data-colonialism" but it can more accurately be applied to the greater flow-states established by Eastern games, and neo-Socialism. Tripathy suggests neoliberalism is anti-democratic in that game rules are constructed by the game company in a "dictatorial fashion" rather than by a "collective body", though said collective-body would surely be an authoritarian state like the PRC that already has insidious reach over the Chinese games industry. "Agency" in games is compelled by ideological forces (Keever), as can be seen in how Liberally-encoded games encourage self-expression, even outside of Liberal society, which is to their merit. *Frostpunk* (11 Bit Studios, 2018) is a Polish city-building survival game,

wherein the goal is firstly the survival of the people, and secondly the balancing of this with morals, i.e. maintaining people's liberties; Chinese players accused it of Liberal (specifically *baizuo* (白左), "White Left") moral-superiority, so collectively establishing a Socialist objective within the game (Harrington & Zhang). Confucianism is more inclined to authority being good in-itself, and judged by its efficacy rather than benevolence (Grayling). Conversely, Japanese *Animal Crossing: New Horizons* (Nintendo, 2020) was removed from the PRC marketplace after means of expression within the game were used for pro-Democracy protest (Davidson, 2020). The British government, too, attempted enforcement of anti-Liberal submissive mindset by funding *Pathways* (2025) — a game aimed at silencing legitimate protest with visual-novel framing giving the illusion of liberal choice. Dissonance with the target audience's ideology similarly led to subversion, with players purposefully taking the "bad" narrative route and adopting the "antagonist" as an icon for the online-Right. The significance of ideology in videogames, when enabled, manifests in conflict that can challenge and synthesise or strengthen points of-view.

Conclusion

Ideology's significance in game-design discourages culturalisation appealing to the common denominator and eroding distinct identities, in favour of resonance with a target audience. Players should adapt to the games they consume, rather than vice versa. Nevertheless, free interaction and dialogue between cultures should be encouraged for the progress of the industry.

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Ludography

This section has been divided between Eastern (Chinese, Japanese, Korean) and Western (North American & European) games for the benefit of comparison within the text.

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